

BAA1019
Bord Bia; Leading the Future of Food
Written Report by INTB7



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Introduction

Bord Bia, Ireland's food and drink authority, champions Irish food exports globally with a focus on sustainability, quality, and innovation. This report analyzes Bord Bia's strategic expansion into high-potential markets, particularly the Halal food sector in the UAE, alongside sustainability-driven innovations.

Using industry frameworks such as SWOT, PESTLE, and Porter's Five Forces, the report evaluates market entry strategies, sustainability commitments, and operational execution across four key stages: Orientation, Diagnostics, Intervention, and Evaluation. It explores opportunities, challenges, and strategic trade-offs while assessing alternative proteins, blockchain-enabled traceability, and carbon reduction initiatives under the Origin Green program.

Through a consultant-led approach, this study provides practical, data-driven recommendations to ensure sustainable market penetration and competitive advantage, supporting Bord Bia's long-term global expansion.

Executive Summary

This written report evaluates Bord Bia's business strategy and market entry into the UAE's Halal food sector while reinforcing its commitment to sustainability and innovation. Through rigorous market analysis and strategic frameworks, this study presents key interventions that will future-proof Bord Bia's success and strengthen its competitive positioning in international markets.

The Orientation Stage establishes the foundation of Bord Bia's expansion strategy by aligning its mission and objectives with market opportunities in the UAE. This stage highlights the importance of Halal certification, quality assurance, and sustainability as key differentiators for Irish beef in a competitive global market. Additionally, an initial industry analysis and competitive assessment outline Bord Bia's growth potential in the UAE's rapidly evolving food sector.

In the Diagnostics Stage, an in-depth PESTLE and Porter's Five Forces analysis assesses external market conditions and competitive pressures. Findings indicate a strong demand for premium Halal-certified food in the UAE, presenting Bord Bia with an opportunity to capitalize on consumer preferences for high-quality, traceable, and sustainably sourced products. A SWOT analysis further identifies Bord Bia's strengths in sustainability, government backing, and supply chain transparency, while also addressing potential challenges such as regulatory barriers and cultural adaptation.

The Intervention Stage outlines the strategic execution plan for Halal market expansion in the UAE. This involves obtaining Halal certifications and forming key partnerships with regulatory bodies such as ESMA, IFI, and HIA. The expansion strategy also incorporates AI-driven marketing and digital outreach, which will enable Bord Bia to enhance consumer engagement and optimize brand positioning. To ensure a strong retail presence, Bord Bia will establish strategic partnerships with major distributors and retailers such as Carrefour, Waitrose, and HORECA. Furthermore, blockchain-enabled traceability systems will be implemented to reinforce quality assurance and food safety standards, strengthening consumer trust in Irish Halal products. To enhance sustainability leadership, Bord Bia will invest in alternative proteins, regenerative agriculture, and carbon reduction initiatives, aligning with global sustainability trends and reinforcing its commitment to environmental responsibility.

The Evaluation Stage focuses on measuring the effectiveness of Bord Bia's strategic interventions through key performance indicators (KPIs). These include Halal sales growth, consumer engagement, and market penetration in the UAE, alongside stakeholder feedback from distributors and regulatory authorities. Additionally, quarterly performance reviews and competitive benchmarking will be conducted to track progress and ensure regulatory compliance. The scalability of the strategy will be assessed to determine potential future expansion into

Southeast Asia, leveraging insights from the UAE market entry. Given the complexities of international market expansion, risk assessment and contingency planning will be essential in addressing regulatory changes, supply chain disruptions, and evolving consumer preferences. Findings from this report indicate that Bord Bia is well-positioned to capitalize on the UAE's demand for premium Halal-certified food while leveraging its sustainability credentials to enhance its market presence. However, market barriers such as regulatory compliance and cultural adaptation must be addressed strategically. The study recommends that Bord Bia adopt a phased roadmap for expansion, beginning with UAE market penetration, followed by a long-term strategy for Southeast Asia. Additionally, continuous performance tracking, stakeholder engagement, and strategic agility will be essential to ensuring sustainable growth and long-term success in international markets.

By integrating Halal market expansion and sustainability innovation, this report provides comprehensive recommendations to support Bord Bia's strategic growth while reinforcing its role as a global leader in the food sector. With the right execution, monitoring, and adaptability, Bord Bia can establish itself as a trusted supplier of premium Halal-certified food while advancing its sustainability leadership on a global scale.

1. Orientation Stage

1.1 Preliminary literature review

A significant role has been placed on suitability as a critical factor in consumer decision-making, with studies highlighting its growing importance in food choices (Verbeke et al., 2007). Bord Bia's emphasis on sustainable practices, such as its Origin Green program, aligns with this trend, offering a competitive edge by appealing to eco-conscious consumers. The provenance of food products, such as Irish-grown goods, plays a significant role in consumer preferences. Research indicates that regional imagery and quality associations, like those tied to Ireland's grass-fed dairy and meat, enhance perceived value and trust (Henchion & McIntyre, 2000). This positions Bord Bia strongly in premium markets. Furthermore, Bord Bia's strategic focus on sustainability and quality differentiates it from competitors, as evidenced by its ability to meet evolving consumer demands for ethical and environmentally friendly products (Matzembacher & Meira, 2019). By leveraging these advantages, Bord Bia can strengthen its market position and drive long-term growth.

1.2 Mission Value

Bord Bia, the Irish Food Board, serves as a vital link between Irish food, drink, and horticulture suppliers and customers worldwide. Established in 1994, it unites industry expertise to drive the commercial success of Ireland's world-class food sector. Their mission is to leverage market insight and industry partnerships to sustainably grow and promote Irish food and drink on the global stage (Bord Bia, 2025). This is the main foundation of how the Bord Bia have been able to establish and maintain value capture. The key insight stems from their ability to align strategic funding, sustainability initiatives, and market development with the needs of Irish producers and global consumers. Bord Bia's were allocated €59.5 million in Budget 2025, a €2.5 million increase from 2024, highlighting its pivotal role in driving market opportunities and enhancing Ireland's global reputation for high-quality, sustainable food and drink. This funding supports initiatives like the accelerated capital allowance scheme for farm safety, which not only improves safety but also boosts operational efficiency, directly benefiting farmers and the broader supply chain.

Bord Bia's value capture is further reinforced by its alignment with *Food Vision 2030* and its role in *Nurturing a Thriving Future* strategy, which focuses on five key pillars: building Food Brand Ireland, fostering customer connections, nurturing industry talent, championing insight-led innovation, and enabling organisational excellence. By leveraging Ireland's unique strengths in sustainability and quality assurance, such as their Verified Grass Fed standard, Bord Bia ensures Irish products command premium value in global markets. This is evidenced by the record €16.6 billion in food and drink exports in 2022, achieved despite global challenges like inflation and supply chain disruptions (Oireachtas, 2023). Alongside this continuous investment in R&D (€21.6 million allocated for 2025) and digital transformation has allowed Bord Bia to ensure that Irish agriculture maintains its competitive edge and fosters innovation. By strategically integrating traditional trade show participation with cutting-edge digital technologies, Bord Bia

creates scalable pathways for enhanced customer engagement and market expansion (Charles O'Donnell, 2024) . Ultimately, Bord Bia's value capture is rooted in a holistic approach empowering producers, building global trust through sustainability, and driving long-term growth ensuring Irish food and drink retain their world-class reputation and remain resilient in an evolving global market.

1.3 Sustainability Vision

A key aspect of Bord Bia's business model is its implementation of sustainability initiatives, which are central to its strategic positioning and value creation. At the core of this effort is Origin Green, a globally unique national sustainability program that unites government, private sector, and the entire supply chain from farmers to producers, foodservice, and retail sectors. Origin Green enables measurable sustainability targets aligned with the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), reinforcing Ireland's reputation as a leader in sustainable food production (Business Plus, 2023). Bord Bia's membership in the UN Global Compact further underscores its commitment to driving positive change and embedding sustainability into the Irish food and drink industry.

The program engages over 55,000 farmers and 300 companies, leveraging scale to drive impact. Through continuous on-farm and manufacturing audits, Bord Bia monitors key sustainability metrics such as greenhouse gas emissions, biodiversity, water use, and energy efficiency. These audits, supported by farmer feedback reports, ensure continuous improvement and accountability. Additionally, Bord Bia is revamping its farm standards and launching the Sustainable Food Processor Scheme to enhance responsiveness to evolving market demands and regulatory pressures.

The strategic goals of Origin Green are clear: to establish Ireland as a global leader in sustainable food production, achieve climate-neutral pathways, and enhance biodiversity through regenerative practices (Oireachtas, 2023). By embedding sustainability into its operations and fostering collaboration across the supply chain, Bord Bia not only meets increasing consumer and customer expectations but also ensures long-term competitiveness and value capture for Irish producers in a rapidly changing global market.

1.4 Identification of key strategic issues

Despite Bord Bia's strong business value proposition and strategic positioning, several key challenges threaten its ability to sustain growth and maintain its competitive edge. These issues require targeted strategies to ensure long-term success in a rapidly evolving global market. The three most critical strategic issues facing Bord Bia are:

1.4.1 Brand Recognition and Market Penetration

Bord Bia's ability to penetrate new markets is hindered by the challenge of building brand awareness and trust in regions with strong local brand loyalty or established international competitors. Consumers often favor domestic or well-known brands, particularly in the food and beverage sector (Tan and Farley, 1987). To overcome this, Bord Bia must emphasize its unique selling points of premium quality and sustainability through culturally intelligent marketing campaigns. While initiatives like the Global Sustainability Insights research provide market-specific data, deeper cultural adaptation is needed to avoid misinterpretation and enhance engagement (Guzel Khabibullinat, 2024).

1.4.2 Political and Regulatory Complexity

Operating within the EU's single market offers advantages, but Bord Bia faces intense competition from local and international players, as well as regulatory and cultural heterogeneity across member states. Economic volatility, political uncertainties like Brexit, and varying consumer perceptions of sustainability further complicate market entry and expansion ((Guzel Khabibullinat, 2024). Tailoring marketing strategies to diverse regulatory environments and consumer preferences increases costs and complexity, requiring Bord Bia to maintain high levels of strategic insight and adaptability.

1.4.3 Climate Change and Sustainability Pressures

Climate change remains a critical challenge for the agri-food sector. While Bord Bia's Origin Green program has strengthened Ireland's reputation for sustainable production, increasing consumer and regulatory demands for measurable sustainability outcomes require continuous innovation and investment (GS1IE, Bord Bia 2025). Bord Bia must balance market value creation with environmental stewardship, ensuring Irish products meet evolving global standards for sustainability and climate resilience.

Addressing these challenges will be essential for Bord Bia to maintain its leadership in sustainable food production and achieve long-term growth in competitive international markets

1.4.4 Market Position

By addressing these key strategic issues and implementing targeted improvements, Bord Bia has the potential to significantly enhance its market positioning and strengthen its competitive advantage. Currently, Bord Bia is a dominant force in the Irish market, They have a strong reputation as a leader in promoting premium, sustainable Irish food and drink. However, despite its strong market position, Bord Bia must remain vigilant of emerging competitors that could disrupt its standing.

One key competitor is the Italian Trade Agency (ITA), which promotes Italy's highly recognizable food brands globally. While ITA emphasizes tradition and quality, it underplays sustainability, an area where Bord Bia excels with its low-carbon, grass-fed production (ITA, 2023; Origin Green, 2023). Bord Bia can leverage its sustainability credentials to differentiate itself in markets where eco-conscious consumers prioritize environmentally friendly products.

Another competitor is ICEX Spain Trade and Investment, which has a strong reputation in halal-certified meat exports, particularly in the UAE. However, Spain focuses less on premium dairy, where Ireland's Kerrygold brand dominates (ICEX Spain, 2023; Bord Bia Dairy Reports, 2023). Bord Bia can capitalize on its premium dairy reputation to gain market share in regions where Spain's presence is weaker.

Their main U.S. competitor, U.S. Foreign Agricultural Service (FAS) benefits from aggressive marketing and strong consumer trust in American brands. While U.S. beef is grain-fed and mass-produced, Irish beef's 100% grass-fed offering positions it as a premium product in markets like the UAE (FAS, 2023; Bord Bia Meat Reports, 2023). Bord Bia can emphasize its unique selling points sustainability and premium quality to compete effectively against U.S. brands.

By focusing on its strengths, Bord Bia can maintain its competitive edge and continue to thrive in the global market.

2. Diagnostics stage: Strategic Analysis of Bord Bia

The diagnostics stage of this project involved conducting a thorough analysis on the positioning of Bord Bia. This required examining both their internal and external environments. As well as this it aims to identify their challenges and key trade-offs they have made as they continue to develop and grow their brand and market reach. In order to carry out this several strategic analysis tools were used, these include the following, a PESTLE analysis, Porter's Five Forces, SWOT analysis alongside insights obtained from various literature. It will highlight their competitive strategy, resources for such and their capabilities as we've identified in the opportunity seen in the halal market.

2.1 Macro-Environmental Analysis (PESTLE)

This was used to evaluate Bord Bia's external environment and the macro-environmental factors that influence their activity. The different areas of influence include political, economic, social, technological, legal and environmental factors.

2.1.1 Political factors

Bord Bias operations are supported by the politics and policies of Ireland. This is as a result of there being a strong presence of support in Irish politics for the agri-food sector. Supportive government policies include Food vision 2030 which is essentially Ireland's plan to guide the development of this sector in order for it to become a world leader in sustainable food systems (Department of Agriculture, Food and the Marine, 2021). Through this Bord Bias capability to deliver their goals and objectives is enhanced. As well as this, regulations like the EU green deal policies exist which aid their strategic goals and play a key role in shaping their compliance and funding compliance opportunities. Other elements of impact include trade agreements and political instability which often as a result impact export opportunities (Smith, 2025). This in particular would prove difficult as it was suggested to look into the expansion of exports in the halal market e.g Brexit.

2.1.2 Economic factors

Economic factors such as inflation risks and currency fluctuations greatly impact the agri-food industry just like any other. This is because it can lead to higher production costs, shifts in consumer spending patterns which impacts market demand and exporting may become more difficult. However if changes in the economic environment are in favour of industry activities it would produce the inverse impact. Bord Bia is already a big contributor to the Irish economy in food and drink exports (Bord Bia, 2025) thus economic volatility would heavily impact them especially in their markets for exports such as the EU and UK. Increasing demand for ethical investments funds that prioritise sustainable food production is an area of opportunity for companies like Bord Bia in this industry to support their sustainability initiatives.

2.1.3 Social factors

Changing consumer preferences constantly prove as an aspect shaping product development and deliverance within this industry. More specifically the rise in the health conscious market with consumers preferring more ethical and sustainable produced food options as well as organic. According to a Bord Bia insight report in Agriland (2024), “68% of all organic shoppers across the seven markets [UK, France, Netherlands, Germany, Belgium, Austria and Sweden] would purchase Irish organic food and drink. Additionally they are seeking carbon labeled products. With the census in 2022 reporting that there was a large increase in the number of people whose religion was Islam (up 32% to 81,830) (CS0, 2023), this number continues to rise in Ireland and globally which presents a new area for Bord Bia to tap into e.g the halal market.

2.1.4 Technological factors

Advancements in technology constantly being developed and improved provides an opportunity for many industries to use it to their competitive advantage. Such advancements include things in digital marketing, AI driven commerce as well as new emerging technologies such as generative AI. They offer new avenues for reaching consumers and managing supply chains. For example Bord Bia has developed AgNav “an online platform providing farmers with support to identify mitigation strategies for their farm to deliver in climate action” (Teagasc, no date). Companies in this industry must stay up to date with rapid change, continuously investing in innovation in order to remain competitive such as with the adoption of blockchain for traceability in sustainable sourcing.

2.1.5 Legal factors

The strict legal regulations particularly around food safety laws and labeling requirements makes it harder to perform well in this industry. Companies must comply with these regulations to continue/obtain market access. The development of new regulations also makes it difficult. For example new sustainability reporting directives such as CSRD (corporate sustainability reporting directive) (Connaughton, no date). Regular audits and consistent stakeholder engagement is required for trust and transparency. Bord Bia adapting their sustainability survey to the corporate sustainability due diligence directive (CSDDD) is an example of keeping in compliance in order to maintain market access.

2.1.6 Environmental factors

With enhanced focus on net zero targets and sustainability concerns, environmental regulations often influence production practices and consumer choices. Programs like origin green focus on these targets for example incentivising the various areas of production or the value chain to adopt better agriculture practices (Bord Bia, 2021). Additionally, climate change itself is a challenge for Bord Bias practices as agricultural production is often affected, requiring possibly more investments in technologies or practices to alleviate this.

2.2 Industry Analysis (Porter's Five Forces)

This framework helps to examine the dynamics of the agri-food industry and the influencing factors that impact Bord Bia performance in it.

2.2.1 Threat of New Entrants

The threat of new entrants for the agri-food industry is moderate as a result of high certification standards. It creates a barrier to entry however Bord Bia with their origin green program already hold a dominant position and strong brand image regarding sustainability which is beneficial for the health conscious market. Stricter and more sustainability regulations also could result in just high quality competitors entering the market.

2.2.2 Bargaining power of suppliers

For this industry it is low because of there being a low supply base. Bord Bia particularly in the areas of farming and producing has a huge network in which they engage with through green - 71, 000 plus (Bord Bia, 2021). Consequently meaning they have alternatives thus reducing their power putting Bord B in a superior position. However if there was to be a reliance on specialised products particularly because of growth in sustainability e.g consumers demanding dairy products from farmers who use the splash plate method for manure application (Bord Bia, 2021). This would increase supplier power therefore it may also be considered low to moderate.

2.2.3 Bargaining power of Buyers

As previously mentioned, there has been a rise in sustainable produced products. With that the bargaining power of buyers is high due to the demand for premium sustainability standards. For example “for dairy, almost two-thirds (64%) of consumers are willing to pay more for grass fed dairy, driven by its strong association with terms such as natural, healthy and premium” (Alley, 2023). As consumers demand high quality and ethical products and sourcing, companies like Bord Bia are forced to maintain rigorous sustainability benchmarks.

2.2.4 Threat of substitute products

This is moderate because of alternative food options such as with the growth of plant-based products. In fact, the number of plant based food companies have tripled since 2010 (Abe-Inge, Aidoo, Moncada de la Fuente, Kwoife, 2024). However with Bord Bias various quality assurance marks this differentiates their product. It therefore puts it to a certain standard that existing customers will be used to.

2.2.5 Industry Rivalry

Rivalry in this industry is high with competition from international competitors like Fairtrade, Nestle and Danone. Additionally with sustainability and company adherence to ESG factors becoming more important many businesses are focusing on this due to consumer preference for

such and it aids in growth prospects. E.g in 2021 Bord Bia reported 71% of origin green companies believe the program provides a competitive advantage for their business.

2.3 Internal Analysis (SWOT)

The SWOT provides an insight into Bord Bia internal strengths and weaknesses.

2.3.1 Strengths

Bord Bia has a strong presence in the Irish market with the origin green program. According to their progress update report in 2021 they had over 71,000 farms and 300+ companies. As mentioned they additionally have government support and they enjoy policy backing providing resources and funding for export initiatives. As well as this their experienced team of professionals and focus on innovation set them apart in addition to their strong brand representation with their products being associated with high quality, authenticity and sustainability (Smith, 2025).

2.3.2 Weaknesses

Bord Bia relies heavily on key markets within the EU and UK. Although their export performance and prospects reports (2025) highlighted that there has been growth in international markets like North America, Asia and Africa, entering new markets requires significant investment and adaptation to local preferences thus entering emerging markets proves to be a challenge. Bord Bia's digital marketing reach is additionally limited particularly in emerging markets and they operate with limited resources (Smith, 2025).

2.3.3 Opportunities

Sustainability and ethical trends have meant that consumers' preferences have shifted demanding healthier and sustainable options. Since COVID "44% of the consumers are willing to pay an average of 9 percent additional price for health and wellness food products" (Ali & Ali, 2020). As mentioned there has been increased growth in international markets which although may prove challenging, they offer potential for example with halal certified products. As well as this constant emergence of technology and AI offer avenues of opportunity to be leveraged which would help in consumer engagement and market reach. Lastly, partnering with other food producers and brands can create synergies and enhance market reach.

2.3.4 Threats

Factors like in relation to stricter policies and regulations from the EU make it harder to perform in the agri-food industry. Bord Bia is required to constantly stay updated with the legal environment to stay in compliance with various laws. In addition international competition, economic volatility, trade barriers and changing consumer preferences can also be noted as threats to their performance. Constant adaptation and innovation is required (Smith, 2025).

2.4 Relevance of Literature Reviewed

The various literature reviewed for this stage of the project provided insights and examples into the aspects of Bord Bia's strategic positioning and influential factors. Different news reports, scientific articles and Bord Bia's own published reports provided information on industry specific data and market trends. Additionally they provided a guide for analysing the different frameworks explored in this stage. They provided a theoretical foundation for diagnosing their strategic challenges briefly mentioned in the SWOT and their trade-offs. Moreover, it provided the basis at which the recommendations and opportunities were identified, particularly concerning the opportunity for growth in the halal market as identified previously.

2.5 Diagnosis of Strategic Challenges & Choices made (trade-offs)

As identified within the challenges section of the SWOT, they face several but have also additionally made trade-offs in their strategic decision making. One of the primary challenges which limit their activity is their heavy reliance on the UK and EU markets. Although their sales have grown there, they risk becoming stagnant if they do not look into emerging markets like Africa and Asia or even other avenues of growth within Ireland. Hence with the growth of the Islamic population in Ireland, expanding into halal certified food production seemed to be a good opportunity for growth.

The other challenge restricting their development is their limited digital marketing reach especially with international competitors already tapping into this. Bord Bia employs a mixed marketing strategy of both traditional and digital, but as mentioned its limited which puts them at a disadvantage because it offers extended reach, personal interaction and relationship building of traditional marketing (Khabibullina, 2024). Bord Bias' choice to mix the two enhances each however to penetrate international markets they must improve the strategies by integrating things like e-commerce, AI, big data marketing analytics as well as culturally adaptive marketing strategies (Khabibullina, 2024).

Bord Bia currently puts more costs into enhancing sustainability initiatives to support long term goals. In relation to challenges, they may need to focus more on new markets as opposed to key drivers to create a good standing within it which in turn would improve the competitiveness. Additionally, the implementation of new developing technologies and digital marketing strategies would improve engagement but they require substantial investments. Balancing these trade-offs will reward Bord Bia in the long term.

3. Intervention

3.1 Identifying Choices Made to Support Current Strategy (Generic Strategy)

As part of the intervention stage of our recommendations, we have made strategic choices to ensure that the implementation of these changes aligns with Bord Bia's current business strategy. The decision to expand the Bord Bia product line to include Halal-certified products and to enter the Middle Eastern market through the UAE is based on Porter's differentiation strategy. We are leveraging Bord Bia's competitive advantage by competing on quality instead of price. This approach allows Bord Bia to maintain its premium quality standards while also complying with Halal quality requirements. This will be achieved through partnerships with local food standard authorities in the UAE, such as ESMA and HIA. These strategic interventions are reinforced by the following choices:

- **Premium Pricing:** Bord Bia will implement a premium pricing strategy by entering the market at a level higher than the average prices for meat and dairy to signify premium quality.
- **Sustainability and Traceability Standards:** Bord Bia has helped establish Ireland's reputation for its sustainability practices within the food industry along with its detailed traceability system. This helps build trust in the market.
- **Origin Green Expansion:** By introducing new sustainable initiatives such as seaweed farming, Bord Bia can set the standard for sustainability while expanding into the growing plant-based market. Through the expansion of the Origin Green program, Bord Bia is strengthening its sustainability and establishing Irish food production as a forerunner in sustainable food production.

3.2 Discussing Strategic Fit Across the Organisation (Activity Map)

Our proposed intervention strategy consists of two main elements: Market Expansion and Sustainability Innovation. The implementation of these strategies is aligned with Bord Bia's current strategy of positioning Irish food products as global leaders in quality. This is done by assisting the expansion of Irish food products in international markets while maintaining its reputation for high-quality products. The following Activity Map displays how the current strategy of operation of Bord Bia contributes to the success of our proposed intervention strategy.

3.2.1 Sustainability & Quality Assurance Alignment:

Bord Bia's focus on sustainable food production practices and quality standards is channelled through its Origin Green program. Our proposed suggestion of expanding this program by introducing regenerative seaweed farming to offset carbon emissions as well as encourage plant-based protein alternatives heightens the impact of the program while retaining its integrity.



3.2.2 Branding & International Promotion Alignment:

Bord Bia's current strategy includes establishing partnerships within retail and food service. This creates an opportunity for Irish food suppliers to reach new markets. Our proposal broadens this activity to a new market of Halal-certified food in the UAE. Through a targeted premium quality branding approach, Bord Bia can introduce high-quality Irish products into the UAE food market. This strategy develops Bord Bia's process by including methods such as digital marketing, trade fairs, and influencer partnerships.

3.2.3 Export Support & Market Access:

A big part of Bord Bia's strategy to expand the reach of Irish products is assisting Irish producers and helping them expand globally. They connect Irish producers with international buyers. Our intervention strategy works seamlessly with Bord Bia's operations, assisting Irish producers to enter the UAE through international business matchmaking. This process includes ensuring Irish producers are in compliance with UAE food regulations and Halal certification standards. This process facilitates the removal of the barriers to entry into the UAE food market for Irish producers.

3.2.4 Global Trade Agreements:

Bord Bia works closely with the governing food boards both domestically and internationally, such as the Department of Agriculture and also the EU Trade Commission. This plays an important role in Irish producers navigating trade laws both domestically and internationally and

allows them to benefit from trade agreements between foreign markets. This operation facilitates our proposed expansion of Irish exports to the UAE food market. Through trade agreements and establishing international partnerships, Irish exporters can penetrate the UAE market and ensure long-term growth.

Through analysis of Bord Bia's operations and activity map, our proposed intervention strategy is perfectly aligned with their core business strategy. Our intervention complements the framework of the international promotion of Irish products that Bord Bia have in place. Our proposed intervention strategy ensures Irish products remain and grow as leaders in the premium food market globally.

3.3 Discuss alignment of strategy to organisational structure

Bord Bia's organisational structure facilitates the international growth of Irish products, market penetration, sustainability initiatives, and brand collaboration. This structure is a central aspect of our intervention strategy and facilitates a smooth implementation. The design of our strategy is influenced by the following structural elements:

3.4 Sustainability & Quality Assurance

Bord Bia's Origin Green program is an important factor in its organisational structure. It ensures Irish food production meets environmental standards and follows ethical sourcing guidelines. Our intervention strategy expands on this program with our proposed implementation of regenerative agriculture, alternative protein promotion, and expansion of carbon offset initiatives. This intervention aligns with Bord Bia's focus on sustainability responsibility.

3.5 Global Trade Support

Bord Bia plays a major role in establishing trade agreements with foreign markets as well as facilitating the compliance of Irish producers with foreign trade laws. This is a vital aspect of Bord Bia's organisational structure, which encourages market penetration and long-term growth of Irish food products in international markets. Our intervention strategy expands this by establishing trade partnerships with the UAE Halal food certification bodies such as ESMA & HIA.

4. Evaluation Stage

In assessing the impact of Bord Bia's strategic interventions, a multi-faceted approach was undertaken, focusing on key performance indicators, financial feasibility, and long-term sustainability. The evaluation is guided by the projected market expansion into the UAE and the implementation of sustainability-driven initiatives under the Origin Green framework.

4.1 Market Performance & Financial Projections

A crucial aspect of this assessment is the financial outlook of Bord Bia's transnational expansion strategy. The global Halal food market, valued at \$2.3 billion in 2024, is projected to grow further, providing an opportune landscape for Bord Bia's market entry into the UAE. Irish beef exports to the UAE currently stand at €0.51 million, a figure that is expected to scale significantly following certification partnerships with ESMA, IFI, and HIA. The strategy of premium pricing is further validated by consumer trends, with 29% of UAE beef consumers willing to pay a premium for quality-assured beef.

The projected revenue model aligns with previous industry growth trends, forecasting a 15% annual increase in sales volume and price. The break-even analysis illustrates a progressive reduction in required export volumes to cover costs, from 6.7 tonnes in 2025 to just 4.2 tonnes by 2029, emphasizing the long-term financial sustainability of the initiative.

Budget Breakdown

- Halal Certification Fees (ESMA, IFI, HIA): €15,000
- Regulatory & Legal Fees: €7,000
- Logistics & Customs Costs: €30,000
- UAE Market Adaptation & Miscellaneous: €9,000
- Total Estimated Cost: €61,000 - €69,000

Projected Revenue Growth & Break-Even Analysis

- 2025: 50 tonnes, Selling Price: €12,750/tonne, Break-even Volume: 6.73 tonnes
- 2026: 57.5 tonnes, Selling Price: €14,075/tonne, Break-even Volume: 5.91 tonnes
- 2027: 66.1 tonnes, Selling Price: €15,428/tonne, Break-even Volume: 5.24 tonnes
- 2028: 76 tonnes, Selling Price: €16,970/tonne, Break-even Volume: 4.69 tonnes
- 2029: 87.5 tonnes, Selling Price: €18,667/tonne, Break-even Volume: 4.22 tonnes

The financial projections indicate a sustainable revenue model where increased premium pricing leads to lower required sales volumes to reach break-even, supporting long-term financial viability.

4.2 Sustainability & Market Expansion Impact

From a sustainability perspective, the enhancement of the Origin Green initiative demonstrates Bord Bia's commitment to environmentally responsible production. The adoption of alternative

proteins and regenerative agriculture methods, such as seaweed farming, provides a dual benefit of reducing carbon footprints while diversifying market offerings. Blockchain integration for improved traceability further reinforces consumer trust, particularly within the Halal certification framework.

4.3 Competitive Benchmarking & Strategic Adaptation

To ensure continued competitiveness, Bord Bia's expansion strategy has been compared against key industry players such as Business France, the Italian Trade Agency (ITA), and the U.S. Foreign Agricultural Service (FAS). A strong differentiator lies in Bord Bia's focus on sustainability, with Ireland's low-carbon production model positioning its exports as premium-grade within the Halal segment. Additionally, Bord Bia's investment in AI-driven consumer insights and digital marketing presents an edge over traditional branding strategies used by competitors.

4.4 Performance Monitoring & Continuous Improvement

The evaluation framework includes quarterly strategic reviews that monitor regulatory changes, stakeholder engagement, and consumer preferences. Producer and retailer surveys will provide real-time feedback, allowing Bord Bia to refine its approach and ensure alignment with market dynamics. Competitive benchmarking will further facilitate strategic adjustments, ensuring Bord Bia maintains its differentiation in premium quality and sustainability standards. Additionally, Bord Bia's evaluation process will align findings with its overall strategy to ensure strategic continuity. Conceptualization within the broader consultant framework will allow for structured adaptation to evolving market conditions. Key findings will be mapped against relevant literature, ensuring theoretical backing for strategic decisions.

4.5 Strategic Recommendations & Future Growth

Building on the evaluation, the following recommendations are proposed for future strategic growth:

- **Strengthening Diversification Efforts:** Expanding beyond the UAE into other Halal markets in Southeast Asia to mitigate risks associated with over-reliance on one region.
- **Enhancing Value Innovation:** Investing in alternative protein research and plant-based meat alternatives to cater to evolving consumer preferences.
- **Leveraging Strategic Change & Technology:** Continuing investment in AI-driven consumer insights, blockchain-based traceability, and data analytics for informed decision-making.
- **Expanding Collaborative Alliances:** Forming stronger alliances with retail giants and foodservice providers to ensure market penetration and sustained competitive advantage.

4.5.1 Alignment with Strategy Consulting Framework

- Strategic Continuity: Findings align with Bord Bia's commitment to sustainability, premium product positioning, and long-term global market expansion.
- Diversification & Alliances: Entering new Halal markets and leveraging strategic partnerships to mitigate regional risks.
- Value Innovation: Aligning sustainability-driven production with premium pricing to ensure differentiation in competitive markets.
- Strategic Change & Technology: Utilizing AI, blockchain, and digital marketing to enhance market penetration and consumer trust.

4.6 Team Reflections on Strategy Consulting

This project provided valuable insights into the role of strategy consultants in developing actionable business recommendations. By integrating financial, sustainability, and market-driven insights, the team successfully aligned strategic interventions with Bord Bia's long-term objectives.

Key learnings include the importance of:

- Data-driven decision-making for financial sustainability.
- Adapting strategy to changing consumer trends and regulatory requirements.
- Balancing cost efficiencies with premium pricing strategies to maintain brand positioning.

The financial feasibility and strategic alignment of Bord Bia's market expansion and sustainability initiatives affirm the viability of the interventions proposed. With a structured evaluation mechanism in place, Bord Bia is well-positioned to establish a stronghold in the UAE Halal food market, setting the stage for further expansion into Southeast Asia. By leveraging sustainability, premium quality positioning, and strategic partnerships, Bord Bia not only enhances its global market presence but also secures long-term financial growth and environmental responsibility.

Through continuous performance tracking, stakeholder feedback, and strategic adaptation, Bord Bia will ensure its interventions remain responsive to market demands, regulatory shifts, and competitive dynamics, solidifying its leadership in sustainable food exports.

Conclusion

Bord Bia is well-positioned for sustainable growth through expanding into the UAE's Halal market and investing in alternative proteins for Sustainable Innovation. The UAE presents a high-value opportunity, with 29% of consumers willing to pay a premium for quality-assured beef. Securing Halal certification and distribution partnerships with retailers like Carrefour and Waitrose will establish a strong market presence. AI-driven marketing and blockchain traceability will further enhance consumer trust and differentiation.

Investing in alternative proteins is essential for future-proofing Bord Bia's sustainability efforts. Expanding the Origin Green program to include regenerative agriculture, seaweed farming, and plant-based protein development will reinforce Ireland's leadership in sustainable food production. With rising global demand for ethical and eco-conscious food, this strategy ensures long-term competitiveness and innovation.

Beyond the UAE, longer-term opportunities include expanding Halal exports to Southeast Asia such as Indonesia and entering Germany's plant-based market, where one-third of the population is vegan or vegetarian. To ensure success, Bord Bia must track key performance indicators (KPIs), engage stakeholders, and continuously refine its strategy.

By executing a phased UAE expansion and investing in alternative proteins, Bord Bia will strengthen its global presence, enhance sustainability leadership, and drive long-term revenue growth.

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Appendices